

YPRES 1914–1918: FLANDERS FIELDS & LOCAL HERITAGE

A 3-Day Immersive Battlefield Study Tour · Thursday 1st – Saturday 3rd October 2026

Base: Peace Village
Hostel
Heuvelland, Belgium

THE CORE MISSION Connecting Our Village to the Memorial Walls of Flanders

On this expedition, our pupils are not passive tourists—they are field historians carrying a profound local mission. Back home inside **Holy Rood Church, Stubbington**, carved into the marble Great War Memorial Tablet and the oak tie-beams of the village lychgate, are the names of three brothers from Manor Way Grange, Lee-on-the-Solent: **William, Cyril, and Eric Lowry**. All three gave their lives across different fronts.

"How did three sons from one coastal Hampshire family, and six young men from our quiet village, find their resting places on the contested ramparts and mud of Flanders?"

During our 3 days, pupils will physically locate and touch the carved names of our local fallen—including **Pte Franklin** and **Pte Ayling** on Menin Gate Panel 35, and **Pte Muckett**, **Pte Rye**, **LCpl Ward**, and **Pte Warland** on the rear panels of Tyne Cot.



Crofton Tablet



2nd Lt Lowry



Lt Col Lowry

3-DAY FIELD EXPEDITION ITINERARY

DAY 1 THU 1 OCT

Departure, North Salient & Medical Triage

06:15 sharp departure from Meoncross School via Jet Connect executive coach to Channel crossing. Cross to France/Belgium. Visit **Essex Farm Advanced Dressing Station** (where Lt Col John McCrae penned *"In Flanders Fields"* in May 1915), followed by the preserved frontline earthworks at **Yorkshire Trench** and the dark basalt architecture of **Langemarck German Military Cemetery**.

Evening: Check-in at Peace Village Hostel, Heuvelland. Hot 2-course group dinner in Ypres.

DAY 2 FRI 2 OCT

Passchendaele Ridge & The Menin Gate Ceremony

Examine the First Gas Attack at **Vancouver Corner** (St Julien Memorial), followed by the mine craters and preserved frontline trenches at **Hooge Crater Museum** and **Sanctuary Wood (Hill 62)**. Afternoon pilgrimage to **Tyne Cot Commonwealth Cemetery** (11,000 graves and 35,000 missing), where pupils will locate our village fallen.

Evening Highlight: Group dinner in central Ypres, followed by attendance at the solemn **8:00 PM Last Post Ceremony at the Menin Gate**, where Meoncross School pupils will lay an official wreath.

DAY 3 SAT 3 OCT

Ypres Town, Everyman's Club & Return Home

Explore the award-winning **In Flanders Fields Museum** inside the reconstructed medieval Cloth Hall. Walk the historic **Ypres Ramparts & Moat**. Drive to Poperinge to experience **Talbot House**—the legendary British soldier refuge and teahouse. Supermarket lunch stop before our afternoon return journey via Eurotunnel/ferry.

Return: Approximate arrival back at Meoncross School at **20:30** (updates sent via WhatsApp).



Follow the Tour Live on Our Interactive App

We have created a bespoke digital field companion for this expedition. Parents and pupils can view daily field notes, interactive satellite maps, the complete 16-poem dual anthology, on-site teacher talking points, and live photo updates directly from any smartphone or computer.

<https://meoncross-history.netlify.app> (Select 'History Battlefield Tour')

MEONCROSS SCHOOL · YPRES BATTLEFIELD TOUR

2026

Essential Logistics, Kit List, Rooming & Parental Checklist

KEY LOGISTICS

Briefing Information · Keep for Reference



FOOTWEAR & WEATHER PROTECTION

- **Sturdy Walking Boots / Waterproof Shoes:** Essential. Broken-in with good grip. Cemetery lawns and trench duckboards are slippery when damp. No flat canvas trainers.
- **Waterproof & Windproof Coat:** Hooded rain jacket. We will be outdoors regardless of light rain.
- **Warm Fleece / Layers:** Autumn in Belgium can be chilly and breezy on exposed ridges.
- **Warm Hat & Gloves:** Mandatory for all pupils. Standing still on the stone ramparts for the 8:00 PM Menin Gate ceremony gets extremely cold.
- **Socks:** At least 4 pairs of comfortable walking socks.



LUGGAGE & DAILY BAG RULES

- **1 Main Holdall / Medium Suitcase:** Placed in coach luggage hold until arrival at hostel. Please label clearly with student's full name. Maximum 15kg.
- **1 Small Daypack (Rucksack):** Stays with student inside the coach. Must contain waterproof coat, water bottle, Day 1 packed lunch, and notebook/pen.
- **Evening Clothes:** Smart-casual clothes for evening group restaurant dinners (clean trousers/jeans, collared shirts/jumpers; no offensive graphics).
- **Washbag & Towel:** Toothbrush, personal toiletries, roll-on deodorant only (strictly NO aerosol cans allowed on coach).



CATERING, FOOD & SPENDING MONEY

- **Day 1 (Thursday):** Pupils **MUST bring a packed lunch** and snacks for the coach journey. No fast food purchases at motorway services.
- **Included Meals:** Full hot breakfasts at hostel (Fri & Sat mornings); substantial 2-course evening group dinners in Ypres (Thu & Fri).
- **Spending Money (Euros):** Pupils require **€20 to €30 in cash**. This covers lunch purchases during supervised supermarket stops on Friday and Saturday, plus any small souvenir or postcards.
- **Water Bottle:** Refillable water bottle for coach and field walking.



TRAVEL DOCUMENTS & DEVICES

- **Valid UK Passport:** Must have at least 3 months validity beyond 3rd October 2026 and issued within the last 10 years. Handed to staff on departure.
- **GHIC / Valid EHIC Card:** Essential for reciprocal healthcare coverage in the EU. Must be valid.
- **European 2-Pin Plug Adapter:** Required for charging mobile phones/devices in hostel bedrooms.
- **Mobile Phone Policy:** Permitted for photography, the web app, and evening calls home. Strictly silenced and stowed during cemetery visits.

Accommodation, Safety & Rooming Allocation Timeline

Expedition Base: Peace Village Hostel, Kemmelbergweg 43, 8956 Heuvelland, Belgium. A purpose-built, secure rural educational centre set in the Flemish countryside, featuring modern en-suite studios (typically 3 to 4 pupils per room), secure access control, and dedicated dining and recreational spaces.

Rooming Process: In **two weeks' time**, pupils will be invited to complete rooming preference slips in school. Mr Lovett and school staff will review every grouping to ensure each pupil is happily paired with close friends in a supportive room. Staff sleep on the same corridors with active evening checks and a strict lights-out policy.

PARENT ACTION ITEMS & NEXT STEPS

ITEM / ACTION	DETAILS & REQUIREMENTS	DEADLINE
Code of Conduct Form	Signed agreement by pupil & parent regarding behaviour and respect at war memorials.	Return by Fri 25 Sep
Medical & Dietary Form	Confirm any food allergies, dietary needs, or prescription medications.	Return by Fri 25 Sep
Passport & GHIC Check	Confirm validity of UK passport (expiry > Jan 2027) & valid GHIC/EHIC card.	Verify This Week
Rooming Allocations	Pupil rooming preference forms issued and finalized in school.	In 2 Weeks' Time
Euros Currency (€)	Provide €20–€30 in cash for pupil Friday & Saturday supermarket lunches.	For Departure Day

Expedition Leaders: Mr Ben Lovett (Meoncross School) & Mr James Garrett (The History Boys) School Base 24/7 Emergency: **+44 (0)1329 288339**